

Chapter 1: The Solar System

1. Introduction

The Solar System consists of the Sun and the objects that orbit it, including eight major planets, dwarf planets, moons, asteroids, and comets. It formed around 4.6 billion years ago from the gravitational collapse of a giant interstellar molecular cloud.

2. The Sun

The Sun is a G-type main-sequence star that comprises 99.86% of the mass of the Solar System. It generates energy through nuclear fusion of hydrogen into helium in its core.